in both north and south India, covering elections. That experience began the hunt to dig below the surface to decipher what really was happening and why these trends were not reflecting in most opinion polls as they should have.

This book is the outcome of pursuing answers to those early questions our data algorithms threw up. About 80–90 per cent of what is in here, I did not know about when we started. It emerged from a deep dive into the BJP and its structures across states, constituencies and domains.

What's New in This Book about the BJP

The New BJP is built on insights gained from several new digital tools that have never before been used in India for political analysis of this kind and on this scale. To create the basis for a deeper, fuller understanding of the BJP, Srivastava and I created a new archival data-mining software, Narad (Normative Analysis of Reporting and Discourse). This allowed us to put together a large, original digital database of 11,588 BJP-linked documents between 2006 and 2019 (consisting of 17.9 million words) that has been assembled for the first time. The use of new AI and machine-learning techniques to examine this vast digitised BJP archive allowed us to see patterns that we would otherwise have missed.

This newly created database on BJP literature includes 8,579 BJP speeches, press releases and party articles published over thirteen years (between 2005 and 2019; 4.98 million words), 168 issues of the BJP fortnightly magazine *Kamal Sandesh* (2009–2019; 2.69 million words), 230 issues of the RSS weekly magazine *Organiser* (May 2015–December 2019; 6.12 million words), 1,305 speeches by Prime Minister Modi (2014–2019; 3.44 million words) and 216 documents of the RSS outfit Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram (literally, 'jungle-dweller benefit hermitage') which works in tribal areas (June 2018–December 2019; 43,000 words). We compared and contrasted this offline literature with social-media posts by seventy-five leaders from the BJP, the Congress and several regional parties between January 2016 and December 2019 (4,76,827 posts in all). This included all Facebook posts by the BJP,